



Save this

AI tools

# Anthropic is giving startups a *free year of Claude*

Plus \$1,000 in API credits.  
How to apply, step by step.

a free **year**





What you get

# \$1,000

in Claude API credits, once

Plus a free year of Claude Team for up to **five Premium seats**, if your company is new to Team.

Source: Anthropic, 6 Oct 2026



01 • Check you qualify

## Founded in 5 years, or funded in 2

Startups founded in the last five years, or funded in the last two, can apply. **No VC needed**: bootstrapped and pre-seed teams are welcome.



02 • Set up the basics

## Console account, matching email

You need a Claude Console account, a company email that matches your website's domain, and a short description of what you're building.



03 · Apply

## Write it like a brief

Apply on the Claude Startups page. Anthropic says it reviews every application. Say who it's for, what it does, and **why Claude**. Two plain sentences.



04 · Claim Team

## Watch for the approval email

It links to the Claude Startups page in Claude Console. Sign in there to claim Team. Credits work on the **first-party Claude API**, not Bedrock or Vertex.



05 · Stack the extras

## Partner offers, up to \$45K

The Claude Startup Stack lists offers like ElevenLabs, Gamma and Granola. They come from **independent companies**, on their own terms, and may not combine.



# What I'd build with \$1,000

01 A brief checker

02 A creator shortlist scorer

03 A weekly report summary

04 A caption first-drafter



The catch

## Read the fine print

Team is free only if you're **new to Team**. The "up to \$7,000" headline assumes five seats at \$100 a month plus credits. Fewer seats, less value.



Save this

Free guide inside

# Save this before you *apply*.

Full breakdown on Build with Vish.

## YOUR TURN

What would you build first with \$1,000 of credits?

Save · Follow for AI x marketing